

the security of a job with a steady income and a high savings rate into the unknown of retirement.

Brad is an example of someone already on the path to FI who accelerated that journey with side hustles. He developed skills experimenting with online businesses, taking small risks while learning. He began to have modest financial success with his blog *Richmond Savers*, and then more success with his web-based business *Travel Miles 101*. The additional security of his side hustle income gave him the freedom he wouldn't have otherwise felt to take the leap and leave his career as an accountant at thirty-five years old.

Another option is to start a business after achieving FI and leaving your career. This is the path I have taken. I saw the potential benefits of starting a side hustle business while working, but I was already saving around 60 percent of my income and was well on the path to FI when I started to consider this option. At that point, it made more sense for me to continue focusing on my career while spending my free time with my wife and young child rather than working more to try to make additional income.

Now that I'm no longer working in my original career, I can devote all my energy to pursuing a business. This has several benefits. The